

CHANGE MANAGEMENT

Fixing a Broken Content Approval Process

A simulated process-improvement and change management project for a fictional creative agency

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Change Lead

The scenario

Loom & Co Creative is a fictional 25-person creative agency running content, social posts, blog articles and ad creative for 12 retained clients.

As the client roster grew, content approvals stayed informal: feedback lived across Slack DMs, channel threads and email. There was no single place to see what was approved, by whom, or what was still waiting on a decision.

NOTE

This is a simulated practice project built to demonstrate process-improvement and change management skills. The company, people and figures are fictional.

Project brief

Client	Loom & Co Creative (fictional, 25-person creative agency)
Project	Content approval process redesign & change management
Objective	Replace an ad hoc, Slack-based approval process with one visible, owned workflow — cutting missed deadlines from 35% to under 10%
Duration	10 weeks : diagnosis through the 60-day reinforcement review
Sponsor	Studio Lead / Head of Creative
Change Lead	Folashekemi Vanessa Joshua (simulated role)
Methodology	Process mapping + Prosci ADKAR change management framework
Team involved	Studio Lead, 3 Account Managers, 6-person creative team, Ops/Project Support

The problem

- Feedback scattered across Slack threads, DMs and email. no single source of truth
- No formal sign-off step, so drafts sometimes reached clients unapproved
- Version confusion: multiple files named "final_v2_actual"
- Unclear ownership: creatives, account managers and clients all edited independently

35%

of approvals ran late (illustrative baseline)

5.2 days

average approval cycle time

THE GOAL

Give every piece of content one visible path from draft to client-ready and bring a skeptical creative team along with the change, not around it.

My role

Change Lead / Process Improvement Coordinator (simulated). I owned diagnosis through rollout.

Diagnose

Mapped the as-is process and identified root causes with the team

Design

Co-designed the new workflow, ownership model and tooling

Land the change

Built the ADKAR plan, managed resistance and ran the rollout

Scope & deliverables

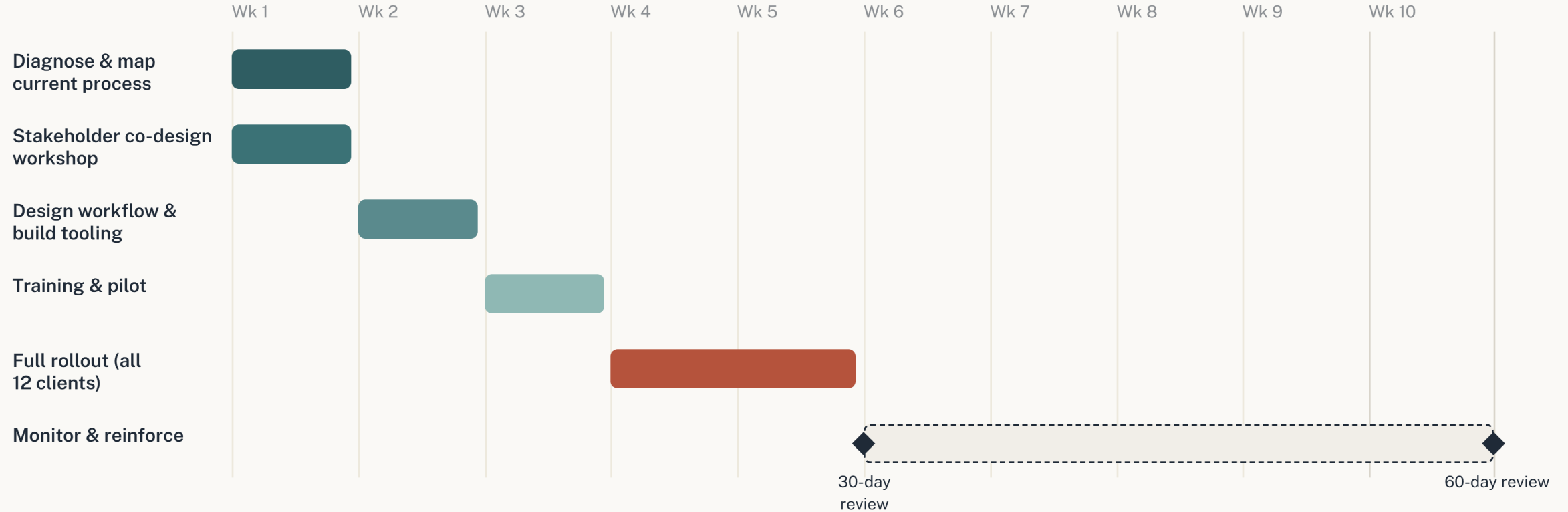
IN SCOPE

- As-is and to-be process maps
- Stakeholder map and RACI
- ADKAR-based change plan
- Resistance management log
- New approval workflow live on a shared board
- Training materials, SOP and recorded walkthrough
- 30-and 60-day reinforcement reviews

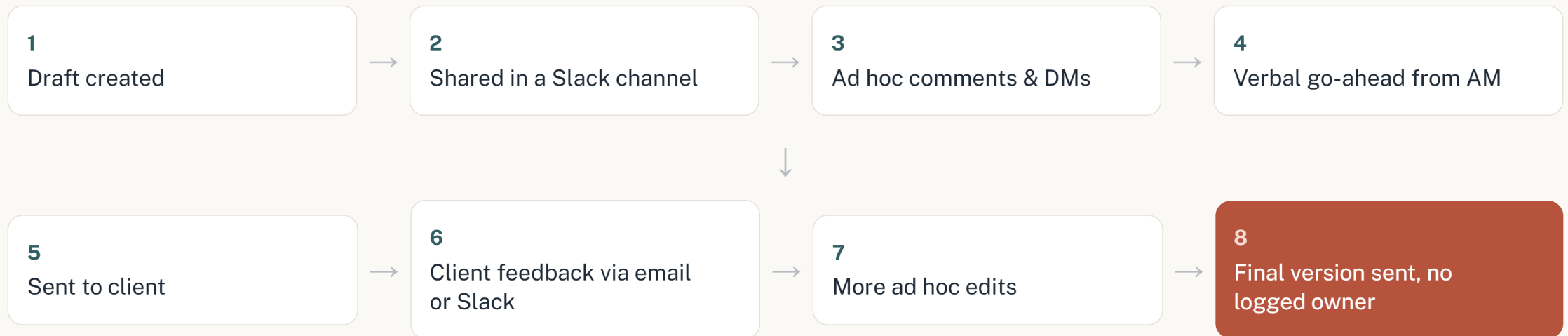
OUT OF SCOPE

- Rebuilding the agency's project management tool from scratch
- Renegotiating client contracts or SLAs
- Compensation or performance-management changes

Project plan — 10 weeks



As-is: the current process



Root causes, not just symptoms

No owner at handoff

Content moved between people with no single person accountable for the next step

Feedback lived in four places

Slack channels, Slack DMs, email and verbal check-ins — nobody had the full picture

No formal sign-off

"Looks good" in a thread stood in for approval — nothing was logged

No version control

Files renamed by hand — teams sometimes worked from an outdated draft

Stakeholder map

Positioned by influence over the process and risk of resisting the change

HIGH INFLUENCE · SPONSOR

Studio Lead / Head of Creative

Approves the new process and models it publicly

HIGH INFLUENCE · DAY-TO-DAY OWNER

Account Managers

Run the workflow day to day — need it to be faster, not slower

HIGH RESISTANCE RISK

Creative team (designers & writers)

Wary that "more process" will slow their work and limit flexibility

LOW INVOLVEMENT · HIGH IMPACT

Clients

Feel the outcome, late or unapproved content — but are not in the internal process

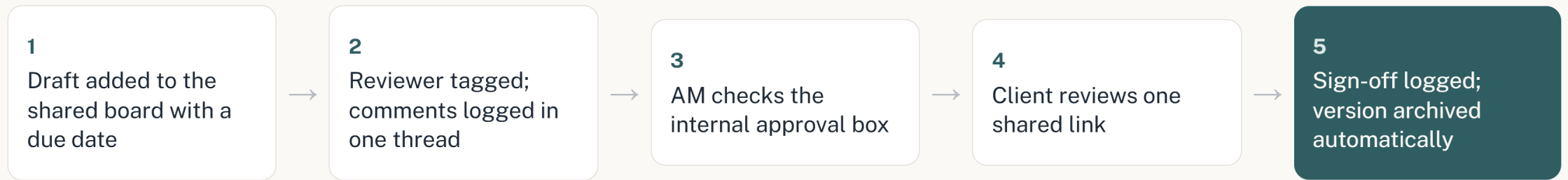
The change plan — ADKAR

Stage	What I did
Awareness	Shared the missed-deadline data (35% late, 5.2-day cycle) at an all-hands and in 1:1s with the most affected creatives
Desire	Ran a co-design workshop so the creative team chose the new tool and shape of the workflow themselves
Knowledge	Delivered two training sessions, a one-page quick-reference guide and a recorded walkthrough of the new board
Ability	Ran a two-week pilot on one low-stakes client with a buddy system and daily office hours
Reinforcement	Put on-time approval rate on a visible dashboard and revisited the workflow at a 30-day and 60-day check-in

Resistance management log

Concern raised	How it was addressed	Status
"This adds more steps to my day"	Showed the time saved from fewer chase-up messages during the pilot	Resolved
"Yet another tool to check"	Replaced four scattered channels with one board — net fewer places to look	Resolved
Senior designer worried about losing creative flexibility	1:1 to adjust checkpoints; kept open comment threads rather than rigid forms	Monitoring
Account managers feared clients would resist a new review link	Kept email as a fallback for the first month alongside the new link	Resolved

To-be: the redesigned workflow



Every step has one owner, one place for feedback, and a visible status — no more verbal go-aheads

Roles & responsibilities

Activity	Creative	Account Mgr	Studio Lead	Client
Draft creation	R	I	—	—
Internal review	C	R	A	—
Client sign-off	—	R	I	A
Final archive & version log	—	R	I	—

R = Responsible · A = Accountable · C = Consulted · I = Informed

Training & rollout schedule

WEEK 1

Co-design workshop with the creative team; finalise the new workflow

WEEK 2

Build the approval board, write the SOP, record a walkthrough

WEEK 3

Two training sessions; pilot the workflow with one client

WEEK 4

Expand to all 12 clients with daily check-ins

WEEK 6+

30- and 60-day reviews; reinforce with visible on-time metrics

Tools used

Miro

As-is / to-be process mapping and the stakeholder map

Notion

The shared approval board, SOP and workflow tracker

Slack

Kept for team communication — scoped down from an approval channel to a status channel

Excel / Google Sheets

RAID log, stakeholder register, resistance tracker and ADKAR action plan

Loom

Recorded walkthrough of the new approval board for training

Google Calendar

Scheduling the pilot, training sessions and 30-/60-day reviews

Before & after (illustrative)

Measure	Before	After (60 days)
Missed deadlines	35%	8%
Average approval cycle	5.2 days	2.6 days
Places feedback lived	4 channels	1 board
Sign-off record	Verbal, unlogged	Logged checkbox

Figures are illustrative targets set for this simulated project, not real client data

Risks & blockers

Risk	Mitigation
Team fatigue from adopting a new tool mid-workload	Phased rollout — one pilot client before expanding to all twelve
Clients resist a new review link over familiar email	Ran both in parallel for the first month; compared response times side by side
Studio Lead becomes a bottleneck on every approval	Delegated the internal checkpoint to senior account managers, with spot checks

Final result & retrospective

WHAT WORKED

- On-time delivery rose from roughly 65% to 92% within 60 days
- One board replaced four scattered channels, no more version confusion
- Co-designing the workflow with the creative team lowered resistance early

WHAT I'D IMPROVE

- Pilot with a client earlier, not just internally, to surface client-side friction sooner
- Start the resistance-management log on day one instead of after issues surfaced
- Set the 30- and 60-day review dates before launch, not after